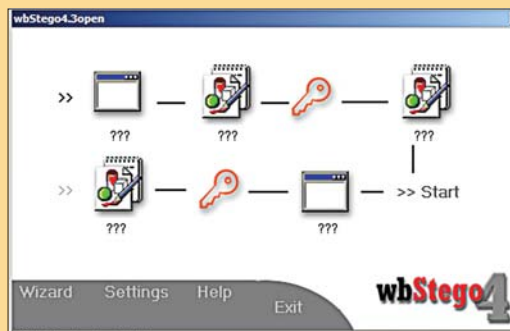




The wizard mode is the easiest to use



The flowchart mode of wbStego4open

STEGANOGRAPHY TOOLS

Steganography software is the digital equivalent of invisible ink. It lets you embed data inside other files. Secret data, of course.

So why use steganography—why not just ZIP your files with password-protection? Well, when you have a password-protected file of any sort, there's something to be explained if and when someone (like your mom or boss!) notices it. ("Hmm. So you're using passwords these days, are you? Tell me more...") Besides, passwords aren't completely safe.

With steganography, no-one will even know there's something hidden! Using the technique, you hide your file inside another, known as the carrier file.

Hide In Picture is once such tool: you can embed files into GIF and BMP images. You retrieve your data from the carrier file just by clicking Extract in the program. You can also password-protect the

carrier file if you're so paranoid you think only you'll survive, and then embed that into another file... Find Hide In Picture on this month's CD or download it from <http://sourceforge.net/projects/hidden-in-picture>.

A similar program is wbStego4open. This open-source, cross-platform tool allows you to embed data in BMP, text, HTML, and PDF files! Get this one from <http://wbstego.wbailer.com>. There are stego programs that allow you to embed data in zipped archives too.

wbStego4open has two modes—Wizard and Flowchart. The latter allows users we call "advanced" to embed / extract data, password-protect files, and compress the carrier file, all in one window.

Steganography opens up a cool one top-corporate-boss-to-another way of exchanging secret messages via e-mail. The sender and receiver need to have the same software installed, of course.



Transparent Rainlendar skins are also available

RAINLENDAR

www.rainlendar.net

Across-platform calendar software, Rainlendar is chock-full of all those much-needed everyday features like to-do lists, alarms, search capabilities, and printing support, apart from the expected calendar.

The software uses the official standard for calendar data exchange set by the Internet Engineering Task Force Calendaring and Scheduling Working Group, called iCalendar, so you can easily import and export entries between calendars. You can set up recurrent alarms, to-do

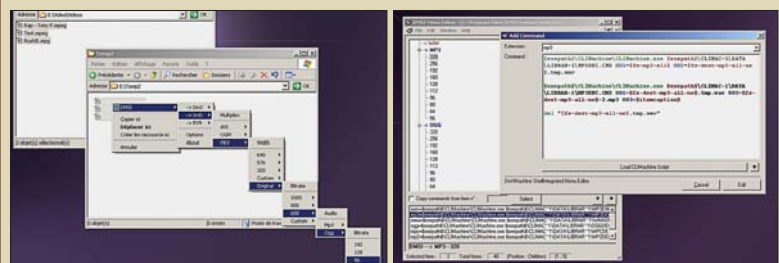
entries, and calendar entries to record recurring events like birthdays, anniversaries, or the signing of an attendance register at work.

The Lite version is free; Pro costs \$15 (Rs 850). The difference is that in the Lite version, there is no support for Outlook, Google Calendar, or calendars shared on a network. Both versions support the Lua scripting language, thereby allowing you to extend the calendar's functionality.

Eye-candy comes in the form of the tons of skins available. Find Rainlendar Lite on our May 2007 DVD.

DIVX MACHINE

www.divxmachine.com



Change any video to any format using DivX Machine

If your work involves managing many video files and changing their properties, DivX Machine will be downright useful. It integrates into the Explorer shell; when you right-click on an image or video file, it lists a host of formats and resolutions to which you can convert the file. You can select multiple files of the same file-type to be converted at once. Head to <http://www.climachine.com/?lang=en&page=featdmsi> to see what media formats are supported.

The common filters like MP3 to OGG converters, AVI to DIVX are all bundled with the software. You can select which filters you want to display in the Explorer shell. There are filters available to enhance the clarity of video called Avisynth filters. You can add these to enhance video clarity. DivX Machine lets you build custom Explorer shell menus from scratch using the bundled DMSI Menu Editor. Find DivX Machine on this month's CD.